

Minor Assignment 2: Published Webpage

Close Reading Literature**Overview****Total points: 30**

This assignment is in preparation for Major Assignment 2. For this assignment, you will close read **three** of the following primary texts. Of the three texts you choose, **at least one must be a poem by a female poet** (choose between Philips, Bradstreet, and Finch), **at least one must be the prefatory material to a play by a female playwright** (choose between Behn and Manley), and **at least one must be an anti-theatrical satire** (choose between Gould and the anonymous *The Female Wits*).

1. Choose **one** from these (**a poem by a female poet**):
 - o Katherine Philips, "[To My Excellent Lucasia, on Our Friendship](#)" (1651-1652)
 - o Anne Bradstreet, "[The Author to Her Book](#)" (1678)
 - o Anne Finch, "[The Introduction](#)" (1713?)
2. Choose **one** from these (**the prefatory material to a play by a female playwright**):
 - o Aphra Behn, [prefatory materials](#) to *The Feigned Curtizans* (1679)
 - o Delarivier Manley, [prefatory materials](#) to *The Royal Mischief* (1696)
3. Choose **one** from these (**an anti-theatrical satire**):
 - o Robert Gould, "[The Playhouse. A Satyr](#)" (1689)
 - o Anon., [prefatory materials](#) to *The Female Wits* (1704)

While choosing the three texts to close read, please also keep in mind that you will have to do a literary analysis of the three in relation to one another for Major Assignment 2.

You will present your close reading as a **scrolling webpage essay** on Adobe Express.

Deliverable

Your close reading should be **700-850 words** in length + an **MLA works cited** section.

Please follow the principles of close reading as outlined in the [Close Reading Literature](#) handout, citing specific evidence from the poems and play prefaces to prove your points. Also incorporate the literary devices you notice in the texts, many of which are listed in the [Tools for Textual Analysis](#) handout.

Close Reading Requirements

Strong close readings:

1. Correctly understand the literal meaning but do not include a full paraphrase or summary.

2. Use details of language in direct quotations, properly cited with line numbers for poetry or page numbers for prose, to provide evidence for argumentative claims.
3. Develop a well-supported, non-obvious argument from textual evidence, making sure to say **how** the quotations prove the claim.
4. Focus on a short passage but keep in mind the larger context of the poem or play or other literary work, ensuring that the argument about the passage works for the poem as a whole.
5. Conclude by drawing together the insights of the interpretation as a whole rather than reiterating the starting premise or thesis.

[This section has been adapted from a discussion board created for a course taught by Dr. Penelope Anderson.]

You may write the close-reading essay on any word processing software of your choice (Microsoft Word, Google Doc etc.), but you will have to publish it in the form of an Adobe Express webpage and submit the shareable URL (that is generated after publishing it, NOT simply copy-pasted from the URL bar on top) for this assignment.

Technical Requirements

Your scrolling essay must include the following:

1. NAME/TITLE: must include your name and an original title (i.e., **not** “Essay”)
2. FORMAT: it can be drafted using any number of word-processing tools, but must be submitted as a **published** Adobe Express webpage. If you password protect your site, be sure to include the password in the comments when you submit the assignment.
3. LENGTH: must include 700-850 words of text
4. VISUALS: must take care to REMOVE any irrelevant visuals. *If* you choose to include visuals on the webpage, I will assume that it has been placed there intentionally to serve some rhetorical purpose, so it must be appropriate in both image content and placement in the webpage.
5. SOURCES: must utilize at least 3 sources and include a Works Cited (at the end of the webpage)
6. CITATION STYLE: must use the MLA citation style in a consistent manner (in-text and in Works Cited)

Submissions

You must submit the final version of this assignment as a **published Adobe Express webpage**. If you choose to password-protect your webpage, be sure to include the password in a comment added to the submission.

Note: If you do not publish it, generate a link and submit that link, and instead just copy-paste the URL from the top of your browser window, I will **NOT** be able to access it, and as such it will **NOT** meet the requirements of the assignment.

The use of AI for this assignment will result in a report of academic dishonesty.

You are encouraged to seek an appointment with [Writing Tutorial Services](#) as you work on this assignment.

Learning Goals

At the end of this assignment, students should be able to:

- Analyze language, form, and rhetorical strategies in primary texts (17th/early-18th century poems and play prefaces) to develop a focused, non-obvious argument supported by textual evidence.
- Explain *how* textual evidence supports your interpretive claims.
- Compare multiple primary texts to explore how different authors respond to shared literary, social, and theatrical contexts.
- Practice Digital Rhetoric by making intentional choices about layout, visuals, presentation, and organizational structure to guide readers through your analysis.

Rubric

Total Points: 30	Rating		
Criteria	Strong	Satisfactory	Needs Improvement
The close reading correctly understands the literal meaning but does not include a full paraphrase or summary. (_/5)			
The close reading uses details of language in direct quotations, properly cited with line numbers for poetry or page numbers for prose, to provide evidence for argumentative claims. (_/5)			
The close reading develops a well-supported, non-obvious argument from textual evidence, making sure to say how the quotations prove the claim. (_/5)			

The close reading focuses on a short passage but keeps in mind the larger context of the poem or play or other literary work, ensuring that the argument about the passage works for the text as a whole. (_/5)			
The close reading concludes by drawing together the insights of the interpretation as a whole rather than reiterating the starting premise or thesis. (_/5)			
Meets the technical requirements and submission criteria of an Adobe Express webpage. (_/5)			